Leaf & Let Die

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Prototype Rulebook — Revision v37 (03)

2–4 players • 90–120 minutes • Ages 13+



Blind Playtest Rulebook

PLAYTEST DISCLAIMER: This document is for prototype playtesting only. Artwork, icons, graphic design, and exact layout remain temporary.

pumpkinfacegame.com

Playtest feedback

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Game Overview

Deep in the forest, your gnome colony gathers in a sacred grove to determine the next **Guardian of the Grove**. With enchanted accelerants, a living Plant Creature can be called forth in minutes — Roots tunneling, Vines surging, Flowers blooming with strange powers—then hurled into ceremonial combat.

You are one of the contenders. You'll build a unique Plant Creature on your **Plant Core** by grafting **Roots, Vines, and Flowers**. From the **Grove**—the shared pool of cards, dice, and tokens—you'll claim new growth and stronger dice as the game unfolds.

Your **dice** are your raw surge of power; your cards are how you shape it—nudging luck, setting up clever turns, and keeping your Creature battle-ready. When your energy fades—those low dice rolls—you draw in shy helpers from the undergrowth, gaining **Critters** and **Wisps**.

Overview

GROW. BATTLE ON COMMAND.

The game cycles through groups of **Cultivation** Rounds, each followed by a **Battle** Round. During Cultivation, grow your Plant Creature. During Battle, put your Creature to the test by competing in Strikes. After the final Battle Round, proceed to final scoring.

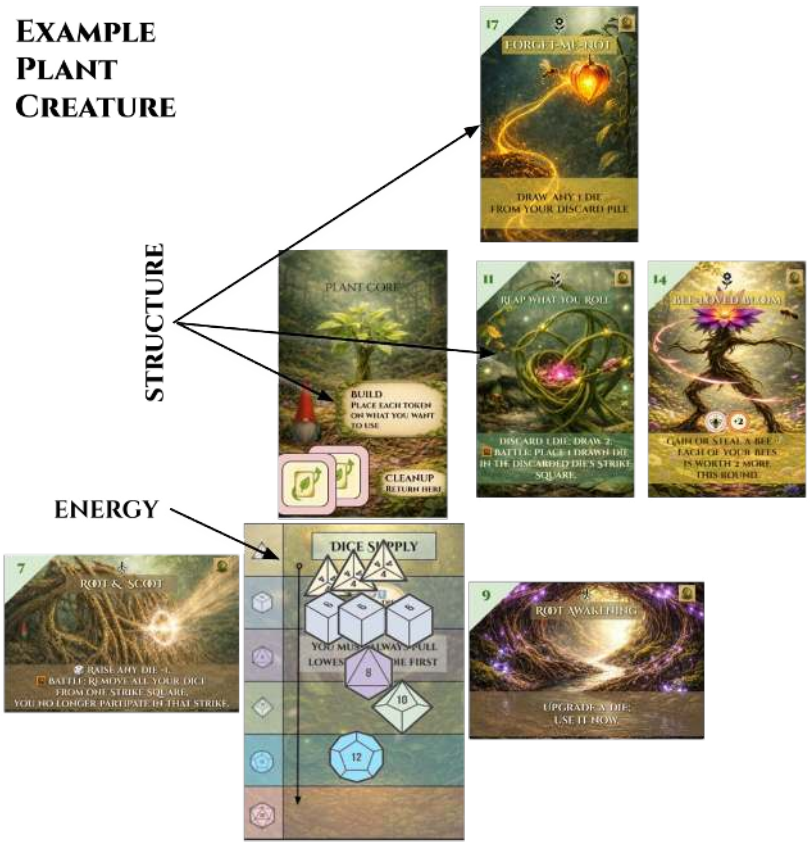
THE PLAYER WITH THE MOST VICTORY POINTS (VP) WINS.

You earn Victory Points in three primary ways:

- **Grow your Plant Creature.** At the end of the game, score the VP printed on each Plant card grafted to it.
- **Win Strikes in Battle.** Gain VP tokens for winning Strikes.
- **Keep Wisps.** At the end of the game, score the VP printed on each unplayed Wisp.

Your Plant Creature: Structure and Energy

CARDS ARE STRUCTURE; DICE ARE ENERGY.



Plant cards are Structure. Roots, Vines, and Flowers are grafted around the Plant Core. Each card becomes part of your Creature and gives it an ability.

Dice are Energy. At the start of each round, you draw and roll dice into your Dice Hand. During Cultivation, their values are resources you can improve and spend to buy Plant cards and stronger dice. During Battle, their values become your attack strength. Spent and leftover dice cycle through your Discard Bin and return in later rounds.

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Components

Plant Cards (216)

Root Cards (72)



Vine Cards (72)



Flower Cards (72)



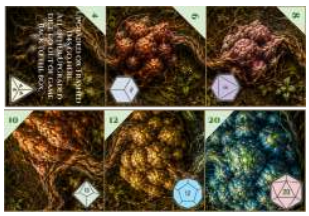
Cultivation Round Cards (12)



Battle Round Cards (6)



Graft Bed Trays



Graft Bed Dice (45) - *9 each*



Wisp/Butterfly Tray



Wisp Cards (32)



Butterfly Tokens (4)



Critter & Resource Tray



Critters (18)



Water Tokens (9)



Mulch Tokens (9)



Sunlight Tokens (9)



Player Components

Discard Bin (4)



Player Dice Supply (4)



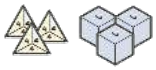
Plant Core (4)



Gnomes (4)



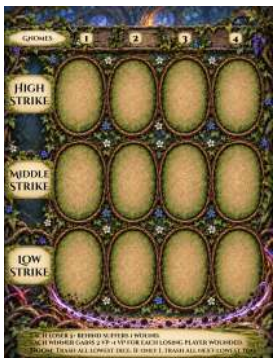
Starting Dice (24)



Main Action Tokens (8)



Battle Glade



VP Tray



Victory Tokens (25 1-VP, 8 5-VP)



Card and Component Key

Plant Cards



Round Cards



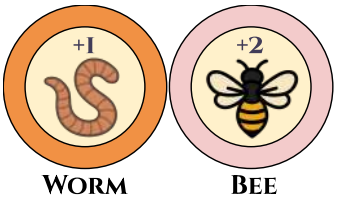
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Wisp Cards





Critters



Plant Core



Resource Tokens



Butterflies



Grove Setup



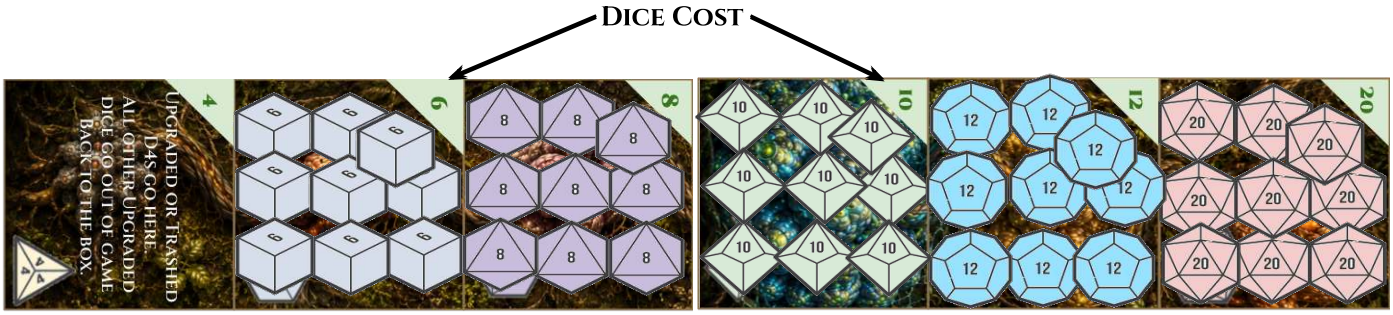
Arrange the shared Grove as shown. The trays hold the shared dice, tokens, Wisps, and Butterflies and remain in use throughout the game.

Graft Bed: The two Dice Trays form the shared supply of dice available to buy.

Other Trays: Hold the shared tokens, Wisps, and Butterflies.

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A — Dice Trays (Graft Bed)



Place both Dice Trays in the Grove to form the Graft Bed. Each compartment starts with 9 dice, except the D4 compartment, which starts empty.

When upgrading dice, return replaced D4s to the D4 compartment. Remove replaced dice of all other sizes from the game.

B — Plant Cards

Create 9 face-up Plant Card stacks in the Grove: 3 Root, 3 Vine, 3 Flower. **Each stack should contain all copies of that card name**.

For your first game, use the following recommended cards:



Roots	Vines	Flowers
⑤ Root Four More	⑦ Vine Yield	⑪ Sapping Snapdragon
⑦ Root Awakening	⑨ Low & Behold	⑭ Bloom Backflip
⑨ Root Kindred	⑪ Vine's the Limit	⑰ Queen's Blossom

Random Grove — Later Games

After your first game, you may randomly choose one card that matches the listed type and cost. Place all copies of each card in a face-up stack.

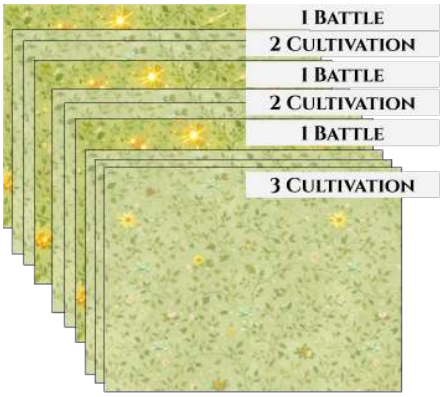
Roots	Vines	Flowers
one ⑤ Root card	one ⑦ Vine card	one ⑪ Flower card
one ⑦ Root card	one ⑨ Vine card	one ⑭ Flower card
one ⑨ Root card	one ⑪ Vine card	one ⑰ Flower card

C — Round Deck

Standard Starting Setup — 3/2/2

Create a 10-card Round Deck:

- Shuffle separately the 6 Battle Round Cards and the 12 Cultivation Round Cards.
- Arrange cards from both decks into a single face-down Round Deck, in this order from top to bottom:



3 Cultivation → 1 Battle → 2 Cultivation → 1 Battle → 2 Cultivation → 1 Battle

The numbers 3/2/2 indicate how many Cultivation Rounds occur before each Battle Round. Keep all cards face down until they are revealed during play.

See Variants on page 19 for other game lengths and Round Deck arrangements.

Return all unused Round Cards to the box. The game ends after the final Battle Round Card is resolved. Leave space beside the deck for the currently revealed Round Card.

Only at the Elders' signal do Gnomes unleash their Plant Creatures into Battle! Control must be displayed.

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D — Critter & Resource Tray



Place the Critter & Resource Tray in the Grove. It holds the shared Worms, Bees, Water, Mulch, and Sunlight tokens.

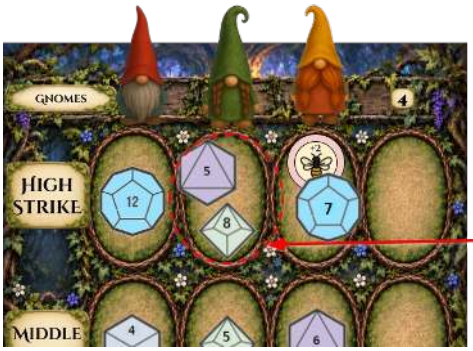
E — Wisp & Butterfly Tray



Place the Wisp & Butterfly Tray in the Grove. Shuffle the Wisp deck it back face down in its compartment.

F — Battle Glade

Keep the Battle Glade beside the Grove. It will be placed in the center when a Battle Round occurs.



Battle at a Glance: During Battle, your dice are placed on the **Battle Glade**. Each horizontal row is a **Strike**. Use your **Plant Creature**, **Critters**, and other effects to strengthen your position. The highest total in each Strike wins **2 VP**; falling **5 or more behind** can cause a **Wound**.

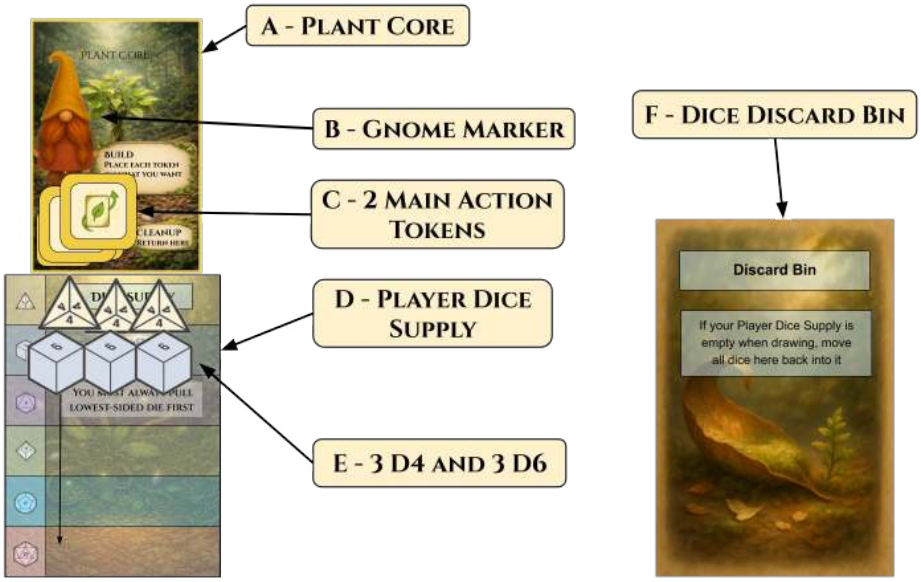
G — Victory Point Tray



Place the Victory Point Tray near the Grove. Players collect VP tokens from this tray as they earn them during battle.

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Set up Each Player Area



Each player takes:

- A — Plant Core: Leave room above and to both sides for your Plant Creature to grow.
- B — Gnome: Place on the Plant Core.
- C — Main Action Tokens: Place both on the Plant Core.
- D — Player Dice Supply
- E — Starting Dice: Put 3D4 + 3D6 in your Supply, with the D4s sorted above the D6s.
- F — Dice Discard Bin

Leave the indicated space between the Supply and Discard Bin as your Dice Hand.

Learn as you Play

For your first game, follow the next sections as you play. They explain what to do and introduce each system when you first need it. Read the Battle section when the first Battle Round Card is revealed. The Almanac is optional reference material.

Cultivation Round

Cultivation Round at a Glance



During Cultivation, all players perform Draw & Roll and Build simultaneously. During Buy, players act in Buy Order.

The Big Idea

Each Cultivation Round, first draw & roll 3 dice to form your Dice Hand. Those dice stay in your Hand as you move through the round; do not roll them again unless an action or effect tells you to. Then use your 2 Main Actions to draw another die, activate Plant cards, or use either Round Effect. Finally, spend dice and Critters to buy new dice and Plant cards. Spent dice go to your Dice Discard Bin; at Cleanup, any dice still in your Hand go there too.

How to Read These Rules

GREEN BOXES = RULES AT A GLANCE.

Green boxes state the rule for that section at a glance. When needed, additional text provides details, examples, and special cases.

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Step 1 — Reveal

REVEAL ROUND CARD.

Reveal the next Round Card.
Cultivation: Both Round Effects are available during Build. Continue below to Step 2.
Battle: Continue instead with Battle, Step 2, on page 14.

Cultivation Round Effects are Sunlight, Water, Mulch, or Compost. Elaborated on page 11.

Step 2 — Draw and Roll (Simultaneous)

DRAW 3, LOWEST FIRST. REFILL ONLY WHEN NEEDED.

All players *simultaneously* draw and roll 3 dice, always taking the lowest-sided available die first. If your Player Dice Supply is empty when you need to Draw, refill it from your Dice Discard Bin and continue drawing.

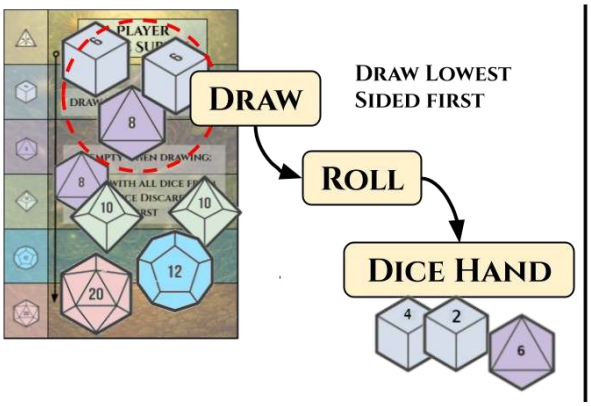
In the first round, your first 3 dice are always your **3 D4s**.

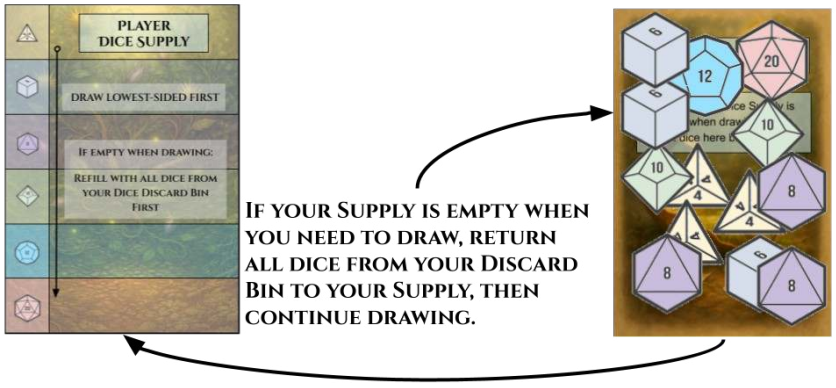
To Draw a die, take it from your **Player Dice Supply**, roll it, and place it in your **Dice Hand** —the rolled dice available to you this round.

Resolve each **Roll Reward** immediately after rolling *(explained below)*.

Player Dice Supply: dice waiting to be drawn.

At **Cleanup** *(explained later)*, spent dice and dice remaining in your Hand go to your **Dice Discard Bin.**





Roll Rewards

1 = CRITTER. 2 = WISP.

After any die roll, immediately gain a Critter for a 1 or a Wisp for a 2. ***Keep the die.***



Resolve Roll Rewards immediately after any roll, including effect rerolls, unless the effect specifically says to ignore Roll Rewards. Any die size can earn a Roll Reward.

*Tip: For the first few times, choose a **Bee** for the Critter reward.*

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Step 2 is now complete. Everyone leaves their rolled dice in their Dice Hand.

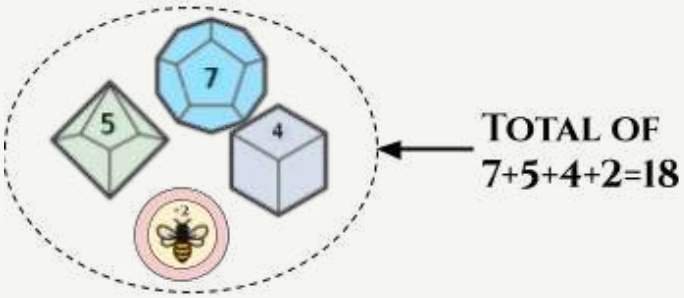
Critters

BEE +2; WORM +1 OR FLIP.

Critters do not change a die face.

Keep them until used, then return them to the Grove.

Bee



Spend a Bee for +2 to a purchase total during Buy, or a Strike total during Battle.

Worm



Spend a Worm for +1 to a purchase total during Buy, or a Strike total during Battle, or spend it to Flip 1 grafted Plant card.

Wisps

PLAY, RESOLVE, TRASH.

Play a Wisp during Cultivation's Build phase, or as a Support Action during Battle. Resolve its effect, then Trash it. Unplayed Wisps score their printed VP at game end.

If you gain the last Wisp, resolve Wispquake immediately as shown on the tray. Wispquake is also explained in the Almanac.

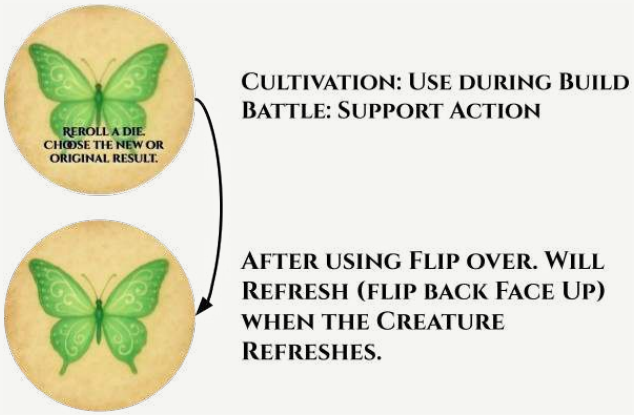
If a Wisp gives you a Butterfly

REROLL, FLIP, REFRESH.

Use — Reroll 1 of your dice; keep either result. Then flip the Butterfly face down.
Refresh — Flip it face up when your Plant Creature Refreshes.
Battle — Using a Butterfly is a Support Action.

Getting Butterflies: Pollinating Wisps award the matching-color Butterfly. Place it face up anywhere near your Plant Creature; its exact position does not matter. If you already own it, Refresh it instead. If another player gains it, it moves to them.

Roll Rewards: A Butterfly reroll earns a Roll Reward only if you keep a different new result of 1 or 2. Keeping the original result if it was a 1 or 2 does not earn another Roll Reward.



Then continue to Step 3 — Build.

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Step 3 — Build: Take Two Main Actions (Simultaneous)

Two tokens, three choices.

During Build, all players simultaneously take 2 Main Actions:

- **Draw** and roll 1 die. Gain Roll Rewards.
- **Activate** 1 face-up Plant card.
- **Use** Round Effect 1 or Round Effect 2.

You may choose the same action more than once.
Use your Main Action token to indicate what you did.

Place each Main Action token where you use it: on your Player Dice Supply, the activated Plant card, or the chosen Round Effect.

Resolve each action immediately. Drawn dice go to your Dice Hand and earn Roll Rewards. After activating a Plant card, flip it face down.

You may also use Wisps, Water, Mulch, Sunlight, Butterflies, and the Worm Flip effect whenever their rules allow. These do **not** use a Main Action token during Cultivation.

Your First-Game Action

During your first game, for the first round, spend your 1st Main Action token to Draw & roll 1 die and add it to your Dice Hand. For your 2nd Main Action choose one of the Round Effects.

Round-Specific Card Effects



Battle Only



Cultivation Only



If a card lists ***Cultivation Only*** and ***Battle Only*** effects, resolve only the effect for the current round type. Unmarked text applies in either type of round.

Limited Grove Resources During Build

First come, first served.

During simultaneous Build, resolve effects immediately. If multiple players want the same limited Grove component, the first player to take it gets it.

Participating Gnomes scramble for every advantage—Cultivation is no orderly queue.

Raise = turn; cap at max.

Whenever an effect says ***Raise a die +1, +2, +3***, etc., turn that same die up by that amount, to its maximum.

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Cultivation Round Effects

Cultivation Round Cards offer four shared Main Action effects: Sunlight, Water, Mulch, and Compost. To use one, place a Main Action token on that effect on the current Round Card.

Sunlight — Gain Token

Place a Main Action token on the Sunlight effect of the current Round Card, then gain 1 Sunlight token from the Grove, if available. During a later Cultivation Build phase, spend it to take an additional Main Action, choosing from the normal three Build options. During Battle, spend it as a Support Action to take an additional Main Action without using a Main Action token or ending your Support turns. Return the spent Sunlight token to the Grove.





Store somewhere near Plant Core.

Water — Reroll or Refresh

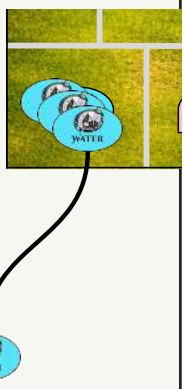
Place a Main Action token on the Water effect of the current Round Card, then gain 1 Water token from the Grove, if available. Keep the Water near your Plant Core. A Water gained this way may be spent beginning in a later round.

Spend 1 Water to choose one:

- **Reroll**: Reroll 1 of your dice and resolve any Roll Reward. In Battle, the die stays in its current location.
- **Refresh**: Turn all your face-down grafted Plant cards and Butterflies face up. Return spent Water to the Grove. During Battle, spending Water is a Support Action.





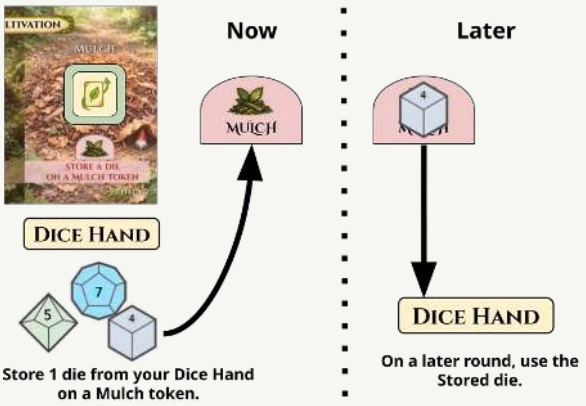


Mulch — Store a Die for Later

Place a Main Action token on the Mulch effect of the current Round Card. Choose 1 die from your Dice Hand and gain 1 Mulch token from the Grove, if available. Place the chosen die on that Mulch token. On a ***later*** round:

- **Cultivation:** Roll the stored die and add it to your Dice Hand. Resolve any Roll Reward.
- **Battle:** As a Support Action, roll the stored die and place it in one of your Strike Squares with room. Resolve any Roll Reward.

After using the stored die, return the empty Mulch token to the Grove. A stored die is not considered part of your Dice Hand.



Compost — Upgrade a Die

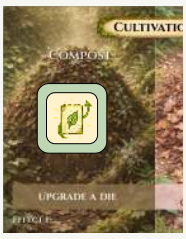
Place a Main Action token on the Compost Round Card effect.

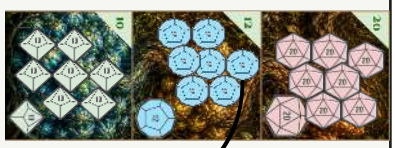
Choose 1 die from your Dice Hand. Replace it with the next larger die size. If the next upgraded die is not available, you cannot do the upgrade.

D4 → D6 → D8 → D10 → D12 → D20

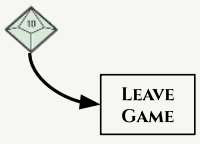
Place the new die into your Discard Bin.

If a D4 was upgraded, return it to the D4 space on the Graft Bed. If it was a D6 or larger, remove it from the game.









After all players have taken both Main Actions, continue to Step 4 — Buy & Grow.

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Step 4 — Buy and Grow

Determine Buy Order

HIGHEST GOES FIRST, THEN CLOCKWISE.

The player with the highest single die in their Dice Hand goes first; Buy Order then continues clockwise.

Compare the highest die in each player's Dice Hand.

If tied for the highest die, compare the tied players' next-highest dice until the tie is broken. If still tied, each tied player rolls a D20; highest goes first.

Buy Cards and Dice

PAY THE COST; DON'T SPLIT DICE.

Spend dice and/or Critters totaling at least the item's cost. Pay each purchase separately; *a die cannot be split between purchases.*

- **Plant card**: Costs appear on the upper-left corner.
- **Dice**: Each die costs its number of sides.
- You may overpay; excess value is lost.
- You may make as many purchases as you can fully pay for.
- Spent dice go to your Dice Discard Bin.
- Spent Critters add their value to the purchase total, then return to the Grove.

NEW PURCHASES WAIT.

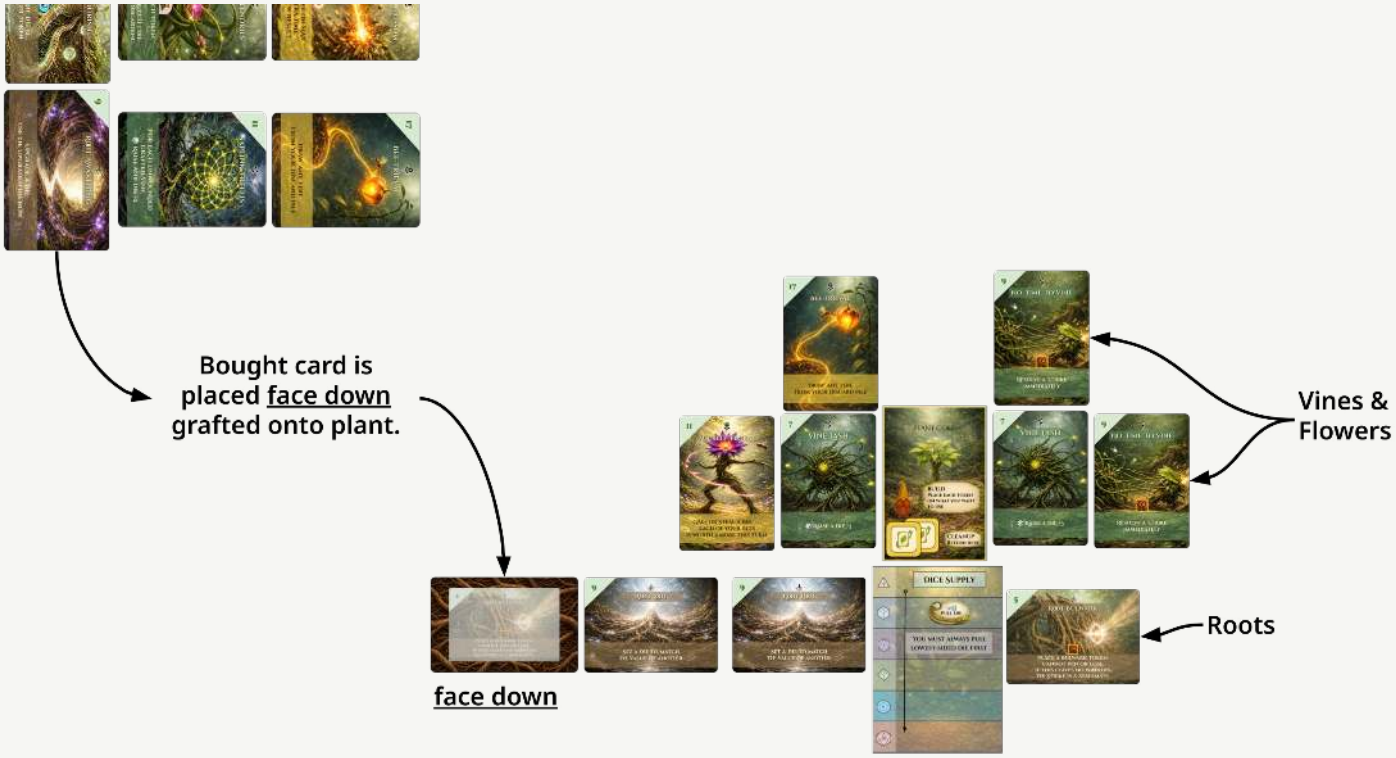
Bought dice go directly to your Dice Discard Bin. Bought Plant cards are grafted face down and cannot be activated until they Refresh.

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Grow Your Plant Creature

FACE DOWN, EDGE-TO-EDGE.

Graft every gained Plant card face down, edge-to-edge in a legal position.



Roots: Place directly left or right of the ***Player Dice Supply*** or another ***Root***.

Vines: Place directly left or right of the ***Plant Core***, or directly left, right, or above another ***Vine***.

Flowers: Place directly left, right, or above a ***Vine***. ***Flowers are endpoints: nothing may be grafted from a Flower.***

Never graft diagonally.

Step 5 — Cleanup (Simultaneous)

DISCARD, RETURN, REFRESH.

At Cleanup, discard your remaining Hand dice, return both Main Action tokens, and—if all your grafted Plant cards are face down—Refresh your Creature.

1. **Discard**: Put every die still in your Dice Hand into your Dice Discard Bin.
2. **Return:** Return both Main Action tokens to the Plant Core.
3. **Refresh**: Your Creature refreshes only when **every grafted Plant card is face down**. Then turn all grafted Plant cards and Butterflies face up together.

Your First Grafts Are Ready

Plant cards grafted during the first round enter face down. Therefore, during your first round, you will always Refresh your plant at Cleanup if you acquired any cards.

Return to Step 1: Reveal the next Round Card.

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Battle Round



Battle Glade

When a Battle Round is revealed, place the Battle Glade in the center of the Grove on top of the Plant cards. VP Tokens will be needed to track Victory Points earned during battle. Each Battle Round has 8 steps.

Battle at a Glance



Step 1 — Reveal

Reveal the next Round Card as you did during Cultivation. If it is a Battle Round, its two Round Effects are available this round. If it is Cultivation, return to Cultivation, Step 2.

Battle Round Card Effects

- **Barkskin**: Suffer a Wound from a Strike only if you lose by 10+ for this round only.
- **Bath**: Refresh as if you just played a Water.
- **Bloom**: Gain 1 VP.
- **Burrow**: Gain 2 Worms.
- **Burst**: Gain D20 to discard.
- **Flow**: Gain any die to discard.
- **Scatter**: Each opponent with Wisps Trashes 1 Wisp of their choice.
- **Sprawl**: Gain any Root or Vine. Graft face down normally.
- **Swell**: Gain D10 to discard.
- **Surge**: Gain D12 to discard.
- **Whisper**: Gain 1 Wisp.

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Step 2 — Draw and Roll (Simultaneous)

Every player draws and rolls 3 dice just as you did during Cultivation. Resolve Roll Rewards normally.

Step 3 — Rank and Place

Highest Left, Highest Top.

Rank players by highest die. In order, claim the leftmost available column with your Gnome, then place your 3 dice highest-to-lowest from top to bottom.



Red claims the leftmost column because their highest die is 19. Green claims the middle column with an 8. Yellow claims the last column with a 7.

Each player then fills their claimed column from highest die to lowest die, top to bottom:

Red: 19, 4, 1
Green: 8, 5, 4
Yellow: 7, 6, 5

Strike Square

Rank players by highest single die. If tied, compare next-highest dice. If still tied, roll D20s to break the tie.

In ranked order:

1. Place your Gnome standing upright at the top of the leftmost available column. Turn it so it faces you.
2. Place your 3 dice in that column from highest value to lowest, top to bottom.
3. If you have fewer than 3 dice, leave the remaining spaces empty; **empty spaces count as 0.**

The Gnomes now show both ownership and Battle order. For the rest of the round, action order proceeds in battle order from left to right.

Have your Gnomes lie down when you are finished taking actions for the round.

Strike Squares and Capacity

3 Dice Per Square.

Each strike square can hold a maximum of 3 dice, and any number of Critters.

Raising, Setting, flipping, or rerolling a die changes its value but does not move it.

Only an effect that explicitly says place, move, or swap changes location.

Your Battle Dice Hand

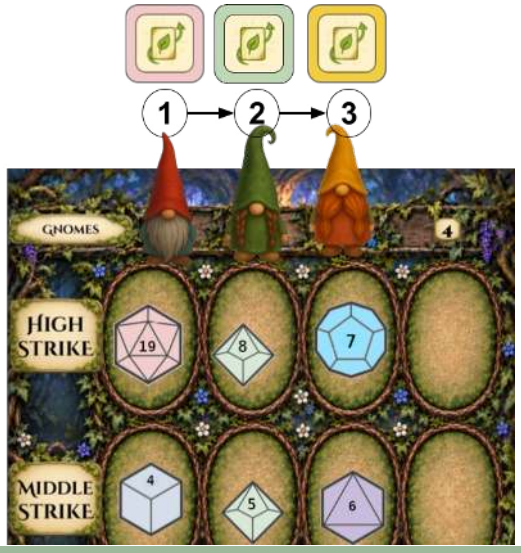
After placing your dice, your dice on the Battle Glade are your Dice Hand for the rest of the Battle Round. If an effect adds a die to your Dice Hand, place it in one of your Strike Squares with room.

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Step 4 — First Main Action

ONE MAIN EACH, LEFT TO RIGHT.

Starting at the leftmost column, every player takes 1 Main Action before doing anything else.



Choose one:

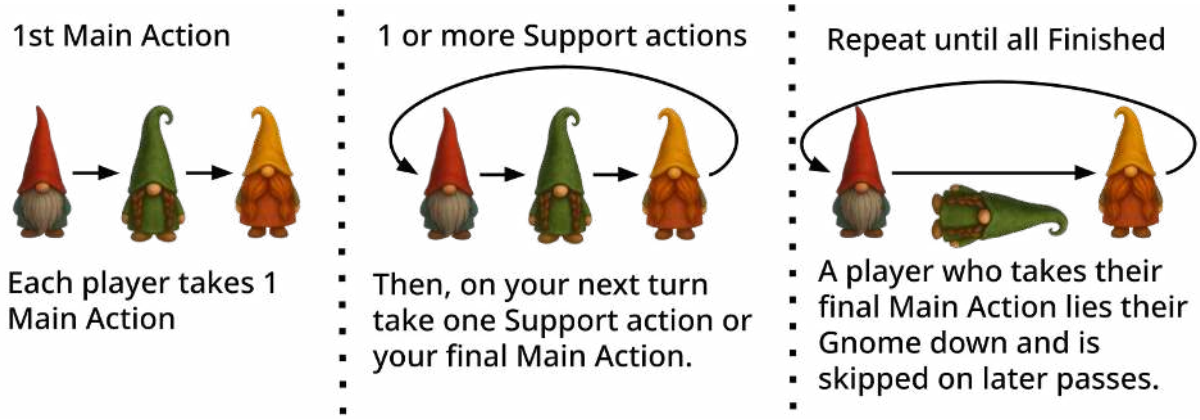
- **Draw** and roll 1 die. Resolve its Roll Reward, then place it in one of your Strike Squares with room.
- **Activate** 1 face-up Plant card. Resolve its effect, then flip it face down.
- **Use** Round Effect 1 or Round Effect 2.

After every player has taken this one Main Action, begin Step 5 in the same left-to-right order.

Step 5 — Support and Final Main Action

SUPPORT OR FINISH.

Repeat passes from left to right. Each time play reaches you, take 1 Support Action or take your final Main Action and finish for the round. Support Actions spend no Main Action token.



Starting with the leftmost active player, proceed left to right. After everyone has taken a turn, repeat, skipping players who have finished. Continue until every player has taken their final Main Action.

The following are Support Actions during Battle:

- **Bee**: Place a Bee in a Strike Square.
- **Worm**: Place a Worm in a Strike Square or use its Flip effect.
- **Mulch**: Use a stored die; rolling and adding it to a Strike square.
- **Water**: Spend a Water to Reroll or Refresh.
- **Sunlight**: Spend a Sunlight token to take a Main Action without using a Main Action token or ending your Support turns.
- **Butterfly**: Use a face-up Butterfly to reroll 1 of your dice, then flip the Butterfly face down.
- **Wisp**: Play a Wisp, following any special timing printed on it.

You may take as many turns to play a Support Action as you have available.

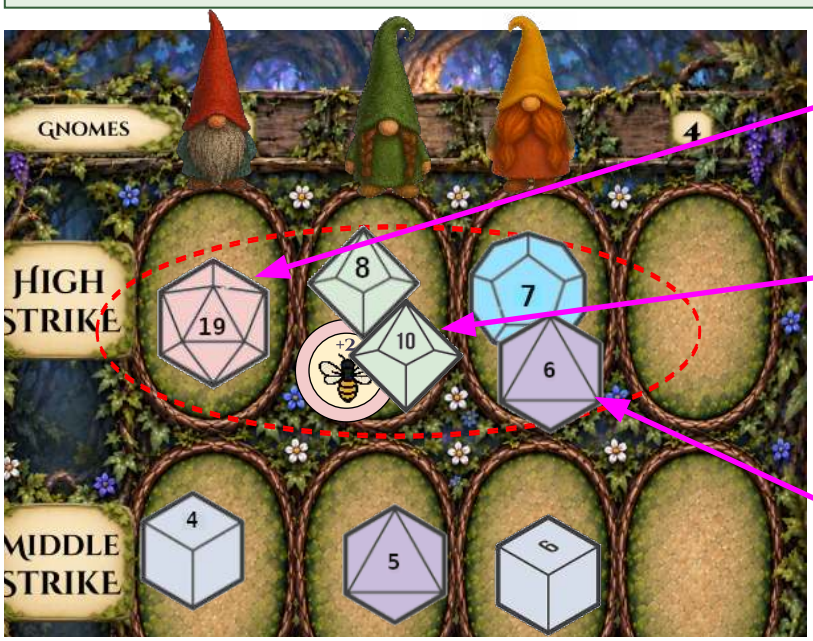
Once you take your final Main Action, you are done for the round. Lie your Gnome down to indicate this.

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Step 6 — Resolve Strikes

TOP TO BOTTOM: HIGH WINS, 5+ WOUNDS.

Resolve Strike Rows from top to bottom. Highest totals win VP; falling 5 or more behind causes a Wound. **Each winner gains 2 VP +1 VP for each losing player Wounded.**



Player 1:
Total = 19

Player 2:
Total = 8 + 10 + 2 = 20
(Winner, earns 3 VP)

Player 3:
Total = 7 + 6 = 13
(Wounded)

For each Strike Row:

1. Total each player's dice and Critters.
2. Highest total wins. Tied leaders all win, unless everyone ties; then nobody wins.
3. Each loser 5+ behind suffers 1 Wound.
4. Each winner gains 2 VP, plus 1 VP per losing player Wounded.

Do not remove the dice from the Battle Glade yet.

Wounds

FLIP IT OR SNIP IT.

When Wounded, *flip* 1 face-up Plant card. If none are face up, *snip* 1 outer Plant card instead.

Return a Snipped Plant card to its matching Grove stack.

You may Snip only an outer Plant card whose removal disconnects no other Plant card.

In the rare case you have no Plant cards left, you gain the Elder's sympathy.

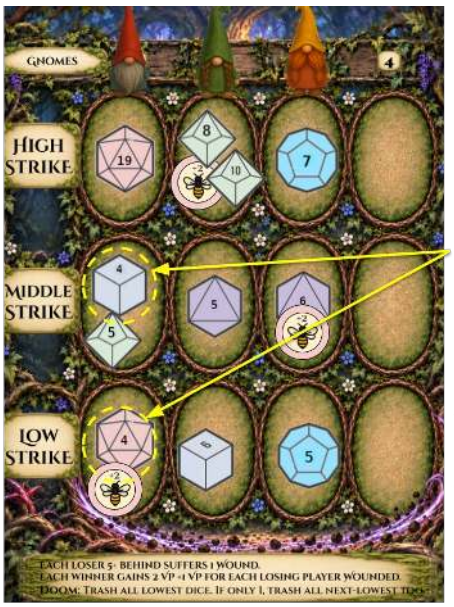


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Step 7 — Doom

LOWEST DICE DIE.

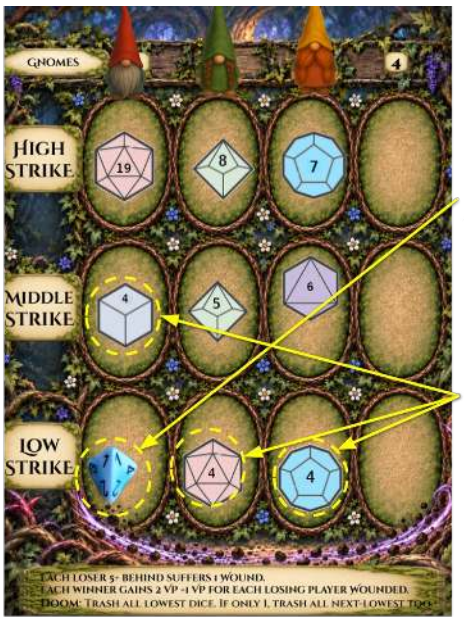
Trash every die showing the lowest number. If only 1 die was Trashed, continue with the next-lowest number so that at least 2 dice are Trashed.



EXAMPLE: TWO OR MORE LOWEST DICE

1. THE DICE SHOWING THE LOWEST VALUE OF '4' ARE DOOMED. THESE DICE ARE TRASHED.

2. AT LEAST 2 DICE WERE TRASHED SO NO MORE DICE ARE DOOMED.



EXAMPLE: ONE LOWEST DIE

1. THE LOWEST VALUE SHOWING IS A SINGLE DIE SHOWING THE VALUE OF '1'. THIS DIE IS DOOMED/TRASHED.

2. SINCE THERE WERE NOT 2 DOOMED DICE THE NEXT LOWEST VALUE OF '4' IS NOW ALSO SELECTED AS DOOMED.

Trashed dice leave the game and return to the Game Box, except D4s. Trashed D4s return to the D4 space on the Graft Bed in the Grove.

Step 8 — Cleanup

RECLAIM, RETURN, REFRESH.

Cleanup proceeds just like it did in Cultivation.

- **Dice:** Place your remaining dice from the Battle Glade into your Dice Discard Bin.
- **Critters:** Return every Critter used on the Battle Glade back to the Grove.
- **Refresh:** If all your grafted Plant cards are face down, turn them and your Butterflies face up.
- **Move** the Battle Glade and VP Tray aside so the available Plant cards are accessible again.

If Round Cards remain, reveal the next one. Otherwise proceed to final scoring.

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Ending the Game

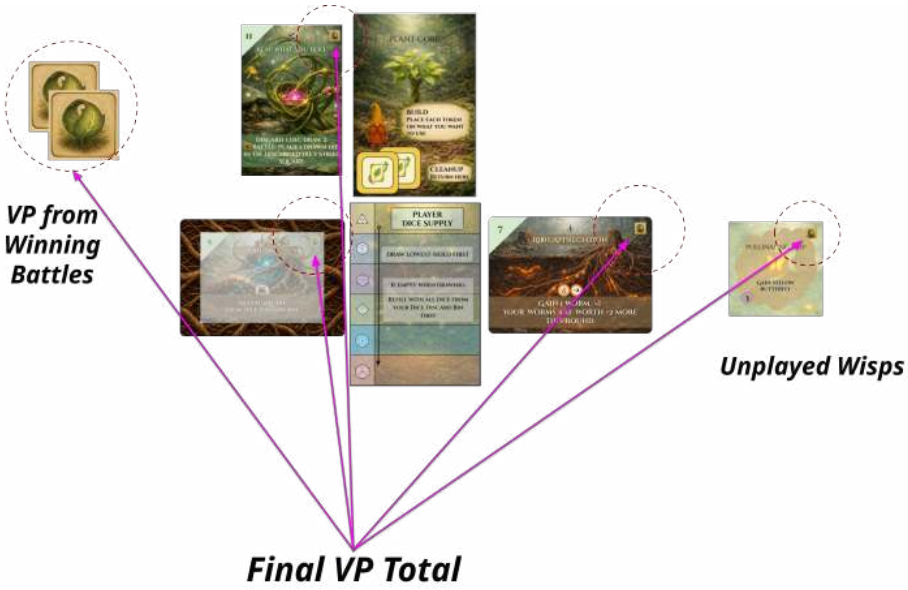
Game End

The game ends after the round in which the final Battle Round Card is resolved.

Final Scoring

TOKENS + PLANTS + WISPS.

Add your VP tokens, VP shown on grafted Plant cards, and VP shown on unplayed Wisps.



Winner and Tiebreakers

Most VP wins. If tied, the tied player with the most grafted Plant cards wins the tiebreaker. If still tied, share the title. The Grove Elders argue if there should be only one. The other gnomes respectfully don't care.

Variants

ROUND DECK EXPERIMENTS

The standard 3/2/2 setup is only one possibility. More adventurous arrangements can produce very different games. In the examples below, C means Cultivation Round and B means Battle Round:

- **Battle Bursts**: 4C → 2B → 4C → 2B
- **Sit and Smash**: 3C → 1B → 2C → 1B → 1C → 1B → 1C → 1B
- **Classic Split**: 7C → 3B, 8C → 4B or even 9C → 4B

Begin with Cultivation, end with Battle, and experiment freely to discover the rhythm your group enjoys most.

Timed Game Option

Before play, agree on a time limit for the game; for example somewhere between **1 and 2 hours**. Start the timer when the first round begins.

- If time expires during a Cultivation Round, finish that round. Discard Round Cards until reaching the next Battle Round Card, then play that Battle as the final round.
- If time expires during a Battle Round, finish it as the final round.

After the final Battle, proceed to final scoring.

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General Rules Reference

Limited Supplies

If a required supply is empty, you cannot gain that component.

During simultaneous Build, limited Grove components are first come, first served.

During Buy and Battle, the normal Buy Order or Battle order determines access to limited components.

Dice Stay Where They Are

Changing a die's value does not move it unless an effect explicitly says place, move, or swap.

Component Destinations

If an effect gives no special destination, use the component's normal destination.

- Gained die → Dice Discard Bin
- Gained Plant card → graft face down
- Spent or unused die → Dice Discard Bin
- Spent Critter, Water, Mulch, or Sunlight → Grove
- Used Butterfly → flip face down
- Played Wisp → Trash
- Trashed card or die → out of the game, except D4s which return to the Graft Bed.

Strategy Tips

Once you know the basics, try these ideas to get more from your game.

- **More Than a Lucky Roll**. Keep your D4s. A low roll isn't always bad. Rolling a 1 earns a Critter; rolling a 2 earns a Wisp. Both can be useful even when the die itself is weak.
- **Worms Can Flip Either Way**. A Worm can flip a grafted Plant card face up or face down. Why flip one face down? If that leaves all your grafted Plant cards face down, your entire Plant Creature can Refresh during Cleanup, ready to use again.
- **Save Some Energy for Battle**. Mulch lets you store a die for a later round. Saving a strong die can give you an extra boost when Battle arrives.
- **Wisps Are Worth Points Too**. Playing a Wisp gives you its effect, but keeping it earns its printed VP at game end. Sometimes holding on is the better choice.
- **Sometimes a Wound Helps.** A Wound flips a face-up Plant card face down. If that completes your set of face-down cards, your entire Plant Creature can Refresh during Cleanup. Sometimes losing a Strike is worth it!

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Root Card Almanac

Root & Scoot (9)

Raise any die +1. Battle: Remove all your dice from 1 Strike Square; you no longer participate in that Strike.

Return the removed dice to your Dice Discard Bin. Return any Critters you had in that Strike Square to the Grove. You no longer participate in that Strike even if the other players continue to change it. You participate normally in the other Strikes.

Root Appreciation (7)

Gain 1 Worm. Each Worm is worth1 more this round.

Gain 1 Worm from the Grove, if available. Each of your Worms is worth 1 more for the rest of this round. This increase is cumulative: if Root Appreciation resolves twice in the same round, each Worm is worth 3 instead of its normal 1.

Root Awakening (7)

Upgrade 1 die; use the new die now.

Upgrade the chosen die by 1 normal step. Roll the new die immediately, resolve its Roll Reward, and use it now. The replaced die, if a D4, returns to the D4 space on the Graft Bed; anything else leaves the game. If the needed die is unavailable when the effect resolves, the Upgrade does nothing.

Root Cause (9)

Flip 1 of your dice to its opposite face.

D4s cannot be flipped. Flipping a die is not a roll and does not earn a Roll Reward.

Root Double Down (5)

Raise ×2 one die.

Double the die's current value, stopping at that die's maximum.

Root Down Payment (7)

Gain 1 VP per die showing 1.

Count all of your dice currently showing 1 and gain that many VP.

Root Four More (5)

Raise any die +4.

The die stops at its maximum.

Root Kindred (9)

Set a die to match another die's value.

Choose a die. Then set another die to that value. The target die cannot be set above its own maximum.

Root Loot (7)

Mulch any die from your Dice Discard Bin.

Choose a die in your Dice Discard Bin and store it on an available Mulch token. The stored die follows the normal Mulch rules.

Root on a Roll (5)

Reroll a die until it rolls 3+. Ignore Roll Rewards.

Keep rerolling the same die until it shows 3 or more. Keep that result. None of these rerolls earns a Roll Reward.

Root Recall (9)

Cultivation Only: Discard up to 2 dice; Draw that many. Battle Only: Reroll 1 of your dice.

During Cultivation, put up to 2 dice from your Dice Hand into your Dice Discard Bin, then Draw the same number normally. During Battle, Reroll a chosen die of yours.

Root Well (5)

Gain 1 Water. Battle: Spend 1 Water to Reroll 2 of your dice or 1 opponent's die.

Gain 1 Water from the Grove, if available. During Battle, you may spend 1 Water to Reroll either 2 of your dice or 1 opponent's die. Resolve Roll Rewards normally.

Vine Card Almanac

Berry Tasty (11)

Raise all your D8s +1.

You may raise by 1 all the D8's in your Dice Hand. Berry Tasty is worth **3 VP** at game end as indicated in its upper-right corner. The Gnome Elder's have a weakness for berries.

Low & Behold (9)

Set a die showing your lowest value to its maximum.

Find the lowest value currently showing among your dice.

If several dice are tied for your lowest value, choose any one of them and Set it to its maximum.

Parting Thorn (9)

Cultivation: You may flip 1 of your Plant cards

Battle: choose 1 opponent; they suffer 1 Wound, and you choose the card affected.

During Cultivation, choose 1 Plant card grafted to your Plant Creature and flip it to its other side. During Battle, choose 1 opponent. They suffer 1 Wound, but you choose the affected card. Follow the normal Wound rules: if they have any face-up grafted Plant cards, flip one of them face down. Otherwise, Snip one of their eligible outer Plant cards.

Reap What You Roll (11)

Discard 1 die; Draw 2.

Put the discarded die into your Dice Discard Bin, then Draw and roll 2 dice normally. During Battle, place the dice where you will. If the die you discarded results in a Strike Square to be empty, that square now counts as zero.

Rise and Vine (9)

Raise all your dice +2. Each affected die stops at its own maximum.

Rise and Vine is worth **2 VP** game end as indicated in the upper right corner.

Saplink Trellis (11)

For each grafted Root or Vine, Raise any die +1.

Count every Root and Vine grafted to your Plant Creature, whether face up or face down. Each one gives you a separate +1 Raise. You may apply several Raises to the same die or divide them among different dice.

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Shift Happens (7)

Cultivation: Flip one of your Plant cards.

Battle: Flip one opponent's Root or Vine Card.

During Cultivation you may flip one chosen Plant card. During Battle, you may flip a chosen opponent's Root or Vine card.

Vine and Again (7)

Use the effect of another spent Root or Vine.

Choose another face-down Root or Vine grafted to your Plant Creature and resolve its effect. Do not change the chosen card's face-down state.

Vine and Dine (9)

Trash 1 Worm or Bee to Raise any die +5.

Return one of your Worms or Bees to the Grove. Then Raise one of your dice +5, stopping at its maximum.

Vine and Punishment (7)

Cultivation Only: Reroll 1 of your dice. If it rolls a 3, Draw 1 die normally.

Battle Only: Choose 1 Strike Row. Reduce all opposing dice there by 3 (minimum 1).

During Cultivation choose a die from your hand to reroll. If it rolls a 3, you may draw 1 more die from your supply.

During Battle choose one Strike Row and physically lower every opposing die in that row by 3. No die can be reduced below 1.

Vine's the Limit (11)

Set a die up to D12 to its maximum.

Choose one of your dice other than a D20 and Set it to its maximum face.

Vine Yield (7)

Raise any die +1.

The Raise stops at the die's maximum.

At the end of the game, Vine Yield scores the VP indicated by its upper-right icon: **1 VP for each Flower grafted to your Plant Creature.**

Flower Card Almanac

Alluring Nectar (11)

Gain or Steal 1 Butterfly. Turn all your Butterflies face up.

Choose one: gain any Butterfly from the Grove, or steal one controlled by another player. Then turn every Butterfly you control face up, including the stolen Butterfly if you took one. Alluring Nectar scores **1 VP** for each Butterfly you control as indicated by its upper-right icon.

Bee-loved Bloom (14)

Gain or Steal 1 Bee. Each of your Bees is worth 2 more this round.

Take 1 Bee from the Grove or another player. For the rest of this round, each of your Bees is worth +2 more than normal. This bonus is cumulative: after two activations, each Bee is worth 6 instead of its normal 2.

Bloom Backbone (11)

For each grafted Vine or Flower, Raise any die +1.

Count every Vine and Flower grafted to your Plant Creature, whether face up or face down. Each one gives you a separate +1 Raise. You may apply several Raises to the same die or divide them among different dice.

Bloom Backflip (14)

Raise a die +1. Battle: Flip each opposing die higher than it in its Strike Row.

Choose a die and Raise it +1, stopping at its maximum. During Battle, after the Raise, flip every opposing die in that die's Strike Row whose value is higher than the chosen die. D4s cannot be flipped.

Bursting Blossom (14)

Raise any die +1; then for each die showing its maximum, Draw 1 die.

First complete the +1 Raise. Then count your dice that are showing their maximum values and Draw that many dice. Resolve Roll Rewards from the drawn dice normally.

Forget-Me-Not (17)

Choose any 1 die from your Discard. Roll it into your Hand.

Choose any die from your Dice Discard Bin. Roll it normally and add it to your Dice Hand. Resolve any Roll Reward normally.

Gust of Petals (14)

Reroll 1 of your dice. Battle: In one Strike Row, all opponent dice higher than one of your dice must reroll.

Resolve the first Reroll normally. During Battle, choose 1 Strike Row. Check each opposing die in that row. If it is higher than at least one of your dice in that same row, it must Reroll. Resolve Roll Rewards from all rerolls normally.

O Edelweiss (17)

Twice, you may play another face up Plant card or flip another card.

Twice, choose one:

- **Play**: Execute the effect of another face-up Plant card, then flip it face down.
- **Flip**: Flip another Plant card, either face up or face down.

Resolve each choice completely before making the next. You may choose the same option twice, or stop after either choice.

Petal To Die 4 (14)

Gain or Steal a D4. Discard any number of D4s. Draw a die for each D4 discarded.

Gain an available D4 from the Graft Bed or steal a D4 from another player from their Hand. Place into your Discard. Then you may discard any number of D4s from your Dice Hand to your Dice Discard Bin. Draw and roll 1 die for each D4 discarded, resolving Roll Rewards normally. At the end of the game, this card scores **1 VP** per D4 you own.

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Queen's Blossom (17)

Draw 2 dice.

Draw and roll 2 dice normally and resolve their Roll Rewards.

During Battle, place each drawn die in one of your Strike Squares with room.

Sapping Snapdragon (11)

Raise any die +2. Battle: In its Strike Row, reduce all opposing dice by 2; Raise it by the total reduced.

First choose a die and Raise it +2. During Battle, in the chosen die's Strike Row, reduce every opposing die by 2, stopping each at 1. Add the total actually reduced to the chosen die, stopping at its maximum.

Transplant Tulip (11)

Draw 1 die.

Battle: You must swap 2 of your dice; Raise 1 of them +2.

Draw and roll 1 die normally. Resolve its Roll Reward. During Battle, after placing the drawn die into a Strike Square, you must swap any 2 of your dice, then Raise one of them +2.

Wisp Card Almanac

Unless a Wisp says otherwise, resolve its effect and then Trash it. An unplayed Wisp scores the VP printed in its upper-right corner at the end of the game.

Berry Patient

Gain 1 VP.

If played, Berry Patient awards 1 VP immediately. If kept unplayed until the end of the game, it scores **3 VP** instead.

Overgrowth

Upgrade +2 available steps; skip missing sizes; use the gained die now.

Follow the die-size ladder: Starting above the chosen die, skip sizes that are currently unavailable on the Graft Bed. The first available larger size is Step 1 and the second available larger size is Step 2. Move the replaced die according to the normal Upgrade rules. Then roll the gained die, resolve its Roll Reward, and use it immediately.

Example: You Upgrade a D4 while D6, D10, and D12 are unavailable but D8 and D20 remain. D8 is the first available step and D20 is the second, so the D4 becomes a D20.

Pocketed Spark

Gain 1 Mulch; store 1 die from your Dice Discard Bin on it.

Take an available Mulch token and place one die from your Dice Discard Bin on it. The stored die follows the normal Mulch rules.

Pollen Theft

Battle Only: Swap 1 of your dice with an opponent's same-size die. No rerolls.

Battle Only: Choose one of your dice and one opponent's die of the same size and exchange them. Do not reroll either die. They keep the values currently showing.

Pollinating Wisp

Gain or Refresh the matching Butterfly.

There are Green, Purple, Red, and Yellow Pollinating Wisps.

Take the Butterfly matching the color shown on the Wisp. If another player controls it, take it from that player, flipping it face up. If you already control it and it is face down, flip it face up.

Whispering Wings

Gain any 2 Critters.

Choose any combination of Bees and Worms.

Wisp of Honor

Gain 1 VP.

If played, Wisp of Honor awards 1 VP immediately. If kept unplayed until the end of the game, it scores **2 VP** instead.

Wisp's Resolve

Battle Only: Resolve 1 Strike immediately. Then return all dice and Critters from that row.

Resolve the chosen Strike using the normal winner, tie, VP, and Wound rules.

Afterward:

- Put every die from that Strike Row into its owner's Dice Discard Bin.
- Return every Critter from that row to the Grove.
- That Strike Row is **closed for the rest of the round**.

Nothing else may be placed in the closed row. Skip it when resolving Strikes during Step 6.

WISPQUAKE — WISP DECK EVENT

All players reroll their Dice Hand. The player who gained the last Wisp may leave 1 die unchanged.

When a player gains the last Wisp from the deck, resolve Wispquake immediately. First, that player may choose 1 die in their Dice Hand to leave unchanged. Then all players reroll their remaining Dice Hand dice. Resolve any Roll Rewards normally. The Wisp deck remains empty for the rest of the game.

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Glossary

Battle Only — Resolve this effect only during a Battle Round.

Battle Round — A round played using the Battle Glade.

Bee — A Critter that adds +2 to a purchase total or Strike total. It changes the calculated total, not a die face.

Buy — Spend dice and/or Critters to gain a Plant card or die from the Grove. The amount spent must equal or exceed the item's cost.

Buy Order — The order players use to Buy during Cultivation. The player with the highest single die goes first; then play continues clockwise.

Critter — A Bee or Worm.

Cultivation Only — Resolve this effect only during a Cultivation Round.

Cultivation Round — A round when players build their Plant Creatures and improve their dice.

Dice Discard Bin — Your personal discard area for spent, bought, gained, and leftover dice.

Dice Hand — Your visible group of rolled dice available during the current round.

Die Size — The type of die: D4, D6, D8, D10, D12, or D20.

Doom — After resolving Strikes, Trash every die showing the lowest number on the Battle Glade. If fewer than 2 dice were Trashed, repeat with the next-lowest number until at least 2 dice have been Trashed.

Draw — Take the lowest-sided available die from your Player Dice Supply, roll it, resolve its Roll Reward, and place it in your Dice Hand unless an effect gives it another destination. If your Supply is empty when you need to Draw, refill it from your Dice Discard Bin first.

End Game — An effect or VP value evaluated during final scoring.

Face Down — A grafted Plant card or Butterfly currently unavailable for use. Newly grafted Plant cards enter face down. When using an effect on a card, it is flipped face down.

Face Up — A grafted Plant card or Butterfly currently available to use.

Flip — Turn a card or token from face up to face down, or from face down to face up.

Flip a Die — Turn a die to its opposite face. D4s cannot be flipped. Flipping a die is not a roll and does not trigger a Roll Reward.

Flower — A Plant card grafted directly left, right, or above a Vine. Flowers are endpoints; nothing may be grafted from a Flower.

Gain — Take the indicated component and place it in its normal destination unless the effect says otherwise.

Graft — Add a Plant card face down in a legal position on your Plant Creature.

Grafted Card — A Root, Vine, or Flower attached to your Plant Creature.

Graft Bed — The shared supply of dice available to buy or gain through effects, held in the two Dice Trays.

Gnome Marker — Your player marker. During Battle it identifies your Battle Glade column and whether you are still taking actions.

Grove — The shared play area containing the Graft Bed, Plant Card stacks, tokens, Wisps, Butterflies, and other shared components.

Main Action — One of the two actions normally taken each round by spending a square Main Action token: Draw and roll 1 die, activate 1 face-up Plant card, or use one Round Card effect.

Mulch — A token that stores a die for a later round. During Cultivation, using the stored die rolls it into your Dice Hand. During Battle, using it is a Support Action and places the rolled die in a Strike Square with room.

Plant Card — A Root, Vine, or Flower card.

Plant Card Stack — A face-up Grove stack containing all copies of one Plant card name.

Plant Core — The center of your Plant Creature and the starting point for grafted Vines.

Plant Creature — All Plant cards currently grafted to your Plant Core and Player Dice Supply.

Player Dice Supply — Your personal supply of dice waiting to be Drawn.

Raise +X — Physically turn a die to a face X higher, stopping at that die's maximum.

Raise ×2 — Double a die's current value, stopping at that die's maximum.

Refresh — Turn all your face-down Plant cards and Butterflies face up.

Reroll — Roll the indicated die again. If no owner is specified, you may reroll only your own dice. A rerolled die stays in its current location unless the effect says otherwise. Resolve any Roll Reward from the new roll unless the effect says to ignore it.

Roll Reward — A reward resolved immediately after a die is rolled: a roll of 1 gains a Critter; a roll of 2 gains a Wisp.

Root — A Plant card grafted directly left or right of the Player Dice Supply or another Root.

Round — Reveal a Round Card and complete all steps for either a Cultivation Round or Battle Round.

Round Card — The card revealed at the beginning of a round. It identifies the round type and provides two shared effects.

Round Deck — The Cultivation and Battle Round Cards that determine the sequence and length of the game.

Set a Die — Physically turn a die to the exact value specified by an effect. Setting a die is not a roll and does not trigger a Roll Reward.

Snip — Remove an outer grafted Plant card that can be removed without disconnecting another Plant card. Return it to its matching Grove stack.

Spend — Use a die, Critter, or token to pay a cost or receive an effect, then move it to its normal destination.

Strike — One horizontal contest on the Battle Glade. The highest total wins 2 VP. Tied highest players all win unless every participating player is tied. A player losing by 5 or more suffers a Wound, and each winner gains +1 VP for each losing player Wounded.

Strike Row — One horizontal row across the Battle Glade.

Strike Square — One player's space within a Strike Row. It can hold up to 3 dice total and any number of Critters.

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Sunlight — A token spent to take an additional Main Action during Cultivation Build or Battle Support, without using a Main Action token. During Battle, it does not end your Support turns. Return it to the Grove after use.

Support Action — An action taken during the Battle Support step without spending a Main Action token. Players take Support Actions one at a time in Battle order.

Swap — Exchange the locations of two dice without rerolling; retain their current values.

Trash — A trashed card is removed from the game rather than returning it to the Grove. A trashed die is also removed from the game, except D4's which return to the Grove. Trashed Critters however return to the Grove and are still available.

Upgrade — Replace a die with the next larger die on the normal ladder: D4 → D6 → D8 → D10 → D12 → D20. A replaced D4 returns to the D4 space on the Graft Bed; a replaced D6 or larger leaves the game. Some effects modify the normal Upgrade procedure.

Vine — A Plant card grafted directly left or right of the Plant Core, or directly left, right, or above another Vine.

Water — A token spent either to Reroll 1 die or to Refresh all your face-down grafted Plant cards and Butterflies. During Battle, spending Water is a Support Action.

Wisp — A card normally gained from a Roll Reward of 2. Wisps do not cost a Main Action to play. During Battle, playing a Wisp is a Support Action unless it says it must be played immediately. Played Wisps are Trashed; unplayed Wisps score their printed VP at the end of the game.

Worm — A Critter that may either add +1 to a purchase or Strike total or be spent to Flip 1 grafted Plant card. Return a spent Worm to the Grove unless an effect specifically Trashes it.

Wound — Battle damage resolved by **Flip It or Snip It**. If you have a face-up grafted Plant card, choose one and flip it face down. If all your grafted Plant cards are face down, Snip one outer Plant card.

Credits

Credits and Version Information

Game design: Douglas Selph

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Assistant Cultivator: Teel Short

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